RESEARCH NOTE · US EQUITY INDUSTRIES · KENNETH FRENCH DATA LIBRARY

Industry All Weather

Can Bridgewater's four-environment risk balance be built from equity industries alone? We classify French industries by growth and inflation sensitivity, build four quadrant portfolios and combine them.

Evaluation window Jan 1965 – Aug 2026 (740 months, monthly rebalanced, before costs) · industry data CRSP 2026-08 · macro: FRED GDPC1, CPIAUCSL

Key findings

SHARPE · AW (A) EW/EW	SHARPE · AW (A) ERC/ERC	MAX DRAWDOWN	BETA / CORRELATION	2000–02 BUST
0.50	**0.53**	**-47%**	**0.98 / 0.95**	**-7%**
market 0.46	best 48-industry variant	market -50%	still an equity portfolio	market -45%

1. **The macro classification is real.** Every quadrant portfolio earns its best return relative to the market in its own regime. With the judgement-based classification (a) the diagonal excess returns are +1.5% / +6.2% / +7.1% / +5.4% a year; with regressions re-estimated out-of-sample they are still +4.0% / +3.1% / +2.5% / +4.5%.
2. **The All Weather combination beats the market modestly.** On 48 industries, equal weights everywhere: CAGR 11.7% vs 10.8%, Sharpe 0.50 vs 0.46, alpha 1.1% a year. Risk-based weights (ERC inside and across quadrants) lift the Sharpe ratio to 0.53 and cut the maximum drawdown to -47%.
3. **It does not deliver Bridgewater-style crash protection.** Beta is 0.98 and correlation 0.95. Balancing industries only diversifies the part of returns that is *relative* to the market (tracking error 5.2%). Market-wide crashes hit almost in full: 1973–74 -45% (market -47%), 2007–09 -49% (-50%).
4. **It shines when the market is concentrated in one regime bet**: 2000–02 -7% vs -45%, 2022 -16% vs -25%. It lags when one regime's winners dominate cap weights, as with mega-cap tech after 2011.
5. **Judgement beats regression.** The macro view (a) gives the best Sharpe ratio at every granularity except 10 industries. Full-sample regressions (b) agree with (a) on 60% of the 48 industries. Out-of-sample regressions (b-OOS) only roughly match the market's Sharpe ratio, because t-statistics of 1–2 make the quadrant labels noisy.

6. **Granularity matters little.** From 5 to 49 industries the Sharpe ratio of (a) ERC/ERC stays in a 0.51–0.53 band. What matters is the regime structure, not the number of industries. Equal-weighting all industries gets worse as the set gets finer, while All Weather does not.

1 All Weather in brief, and how we translate it

Bridgewater's All Weather portfolio, launched in 1996, starts from the view that asset prices move when **growth** and **inflation** differ from what is discounted. Each can come in above or below expectations, giving four environments. Each asset class is biased toward some of them: equities and credit like rising growth, nominal bonds like falling growth and falling inflation, and commodities and inflation-linked bonds like rising inflation. All Weather holds a portfolio for each environment and gives them **equal risk**, using leverage on low-volatility assets, so it does not have to forecast which environment comes next.

	INFLATION RISING	INFLATION FALLING
GROWTH RISING	**G↑ I↑ · reflation** Asset classes: commodities, EM credit, linkers. Our industries: steel, machinery, mines, paper, banks.	**G↑ I↓ · goldilocks** Asset classes: equities, corporate credit. Our industries: tech, autos, retail, restaurants, apparel.
GROWTH FALLING	**G↓ I↑ · stagflation** Asset classes: linkers, gold, commodities. Our industries: gold, oil, agriculture, food, tobacco, defence.	**G↓ I↓ · disinflationary bust** Asset classes: nominal bonds. Our industries: utilities, telecom, drugs, healthcare, insurance.

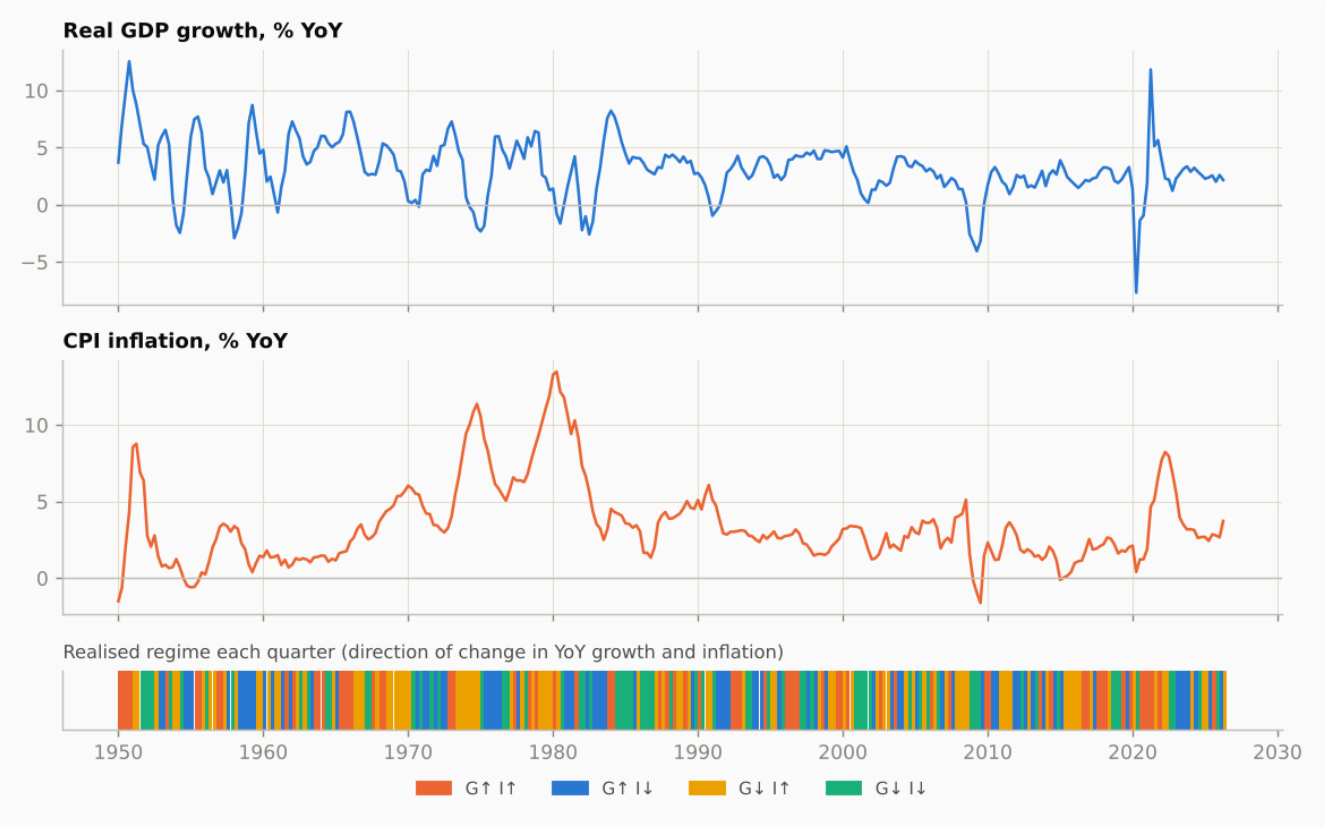
Here the investable universe is **only US equity industries**. So each industry is classified by how its return **in excess of the equity market** responds to growth and inflation. Quadrant portfolios are long-only industry baskets, and All Weather is a fully invested, unlevered mix of the four.

> This changes what the exercise can achieve. Every industry carries a market beta near one, so balancing them diversifies the regime-driven *relative* returns and leaves the market factor untouched. Bridgewater's version gets most of its crash protection from bonds. Ours can only beat the market by tilting away from whichever regime bet the cap-weighted index happens to be concentrated in.

2 Measuring growth and inflation regimes

Growth is year-on-year real GDP growth; inflation is year-on-year CPI inflation (quarterly average of monthly CPI). Bridgewater frames regimes relative to expectations. Without a long consensus-forecast history, we use the **quarter-on-quarter change** in those YoY rates as the surprise proxy: growth is "rising" when YoY growth accelerates. From 1948Q2 to 2026Q2 the

313 quarters split 69 / 78 / 94 / 72 across G↑I↑ / G↑I↓ / G↓I↑ / G↓I↓, and the regime changes in 61% of quarters. That is why a static, balanced portfolio makes sense: the regime is hard to time.



Quarterly regime = sign of the change in YoY real GDP growth × sign of the change in YoY CPI inflation. Macro data from FRED.

3 Classifying industries

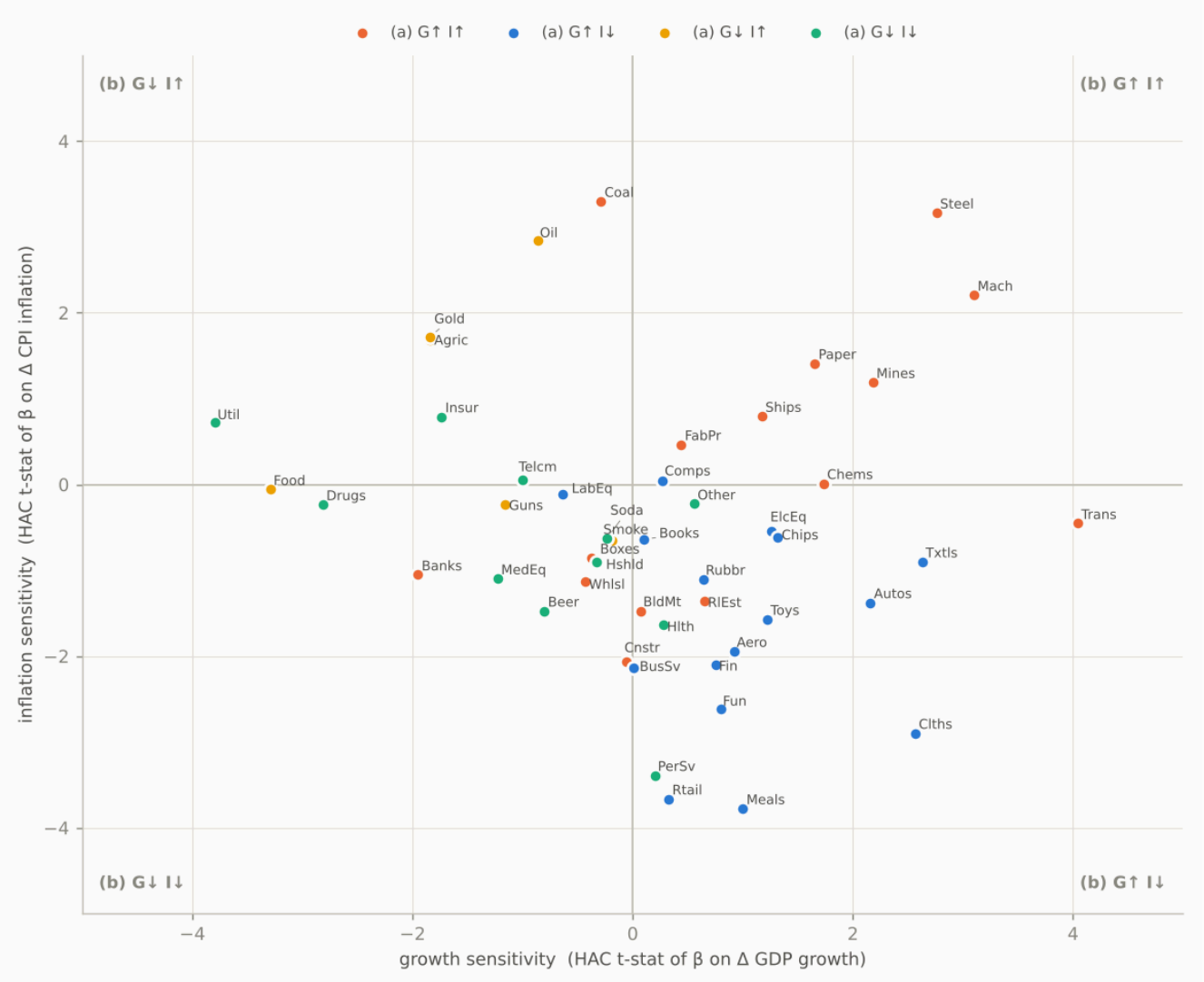
(a) Macro-economic view

Each industry gets a judgement score of ±1 or ±2 on growth and on inflation, based on its business economics: commodity exposure, pricing power, demand elasticity, cash-flow duration and rate sensitivity. Gold miners are the textbook stagflation hedge (G↓ I↑). Oil follows the 1973/79/2022 supply-shock pattern (G↓ I↑). Steel and machinery are capex-cycle commodity producers (G↑ I↑). Tech, autos and restaurants are long-duration or discretionary (G↑ I↓). Utilities, telecoms and drugs are bond proxies (G↓ I↓). The sign pair sets the quadrant. Scores were written down before looking at any regression.

(b) Regression view

Quarterly industry return minus market return is regressed on the standardised changes in YoY GDP growth and YoY CPI inflation (both entered together, clipped at ±3σ to contain the 2020 swing, Newey-West t-stats with 4 lags, 1948Q2–2026Q2). The signs of the two betas set the quadrant. A strictly out-of-sample version (**b-OOS**) re-estimates every January on an expanding window, using data only through Q3 of the prior year.

If a quadrant would be empty (only at coarse levels), the industry with the highest score in that direction is borrowed into it. The chart shows both views at once: position is the regression t-statistics (b), colour is the macro view (a). Industries whose colour matches their corner are the 60% where the two agree.



48 industries. Axes: HAC t-statistics of the growth and inflation betas of industry-minus-market returns (b). Colour: judgement quadrant (a). The two views agree on the growth sign for 81% of industries and on the inflation sign for 71%.

The regressions support the textbook macro calls: coal, oil, steel, machinery, gold and agriculture load positively on inflation surprises, while restaurants, retail, apparel and consumer services are hurt. The surprises are interesting too. **Banks** behave defensively rather than as reflation trades. **Utilities** and **insurers** carry slightly positive inflation betas once the market is netted out. **Construction** and **building materials** act as rate-sensitive housing plays (I↓) rather than real-asset plays.

Growth ↑ / Inflation ↑

(a) Chems, BldMt, Cnstr, Steel, FabPr, Mach, Ships, Mines, Coal, Paper, Boxes, Trans, Whlsl, Banks, RlEst

(b) Chems, Steel, FabPr, Mach, Ships, Mines, Comps, Paper

Growth ↑ / Inflation ↓

(a) Toys, Fun, Books, Clths, Rubbr, Txtls, ElcEq, Autos, Aero, BusSv, Comps, Chips, LabEq, Rtail, Meals, Fin

(b) Toys, Fun, Books, Clths, Hlth, Rubbr, Txtls, BldMt, ElcEq, Autos, Aero, PerSv, BusSv, Chips, Trans, Rtail, Meals, RlEst, Fin, Other

Growth ↓ / Inflation ↑

(a) Agric, Food, Smoke, Guns, Gold, Oil

(b) Agric, Gold, Coal, Oil, Util, Telcm, Insur

Growth ↓ / Inflation ↓

(a) Soda, Beer, Hshld, Hlth, MedEq, Drugs, Util, Telcm, PerSv, Insur, Other

(b) Food, Soda, Beer, Smoke, Hshld, MedEq, Drugs, Cnstr, Guns, LabEq, Boxes, Whlsl, Banks

Agreement between (a) and (b) at each level

	5	10	12	17	30	38	
same quadrant	60%	70%	67%	47%	67%	55%	
same growth sign	80%	100%	92%	76%	87%	76%	
same inflation sign	80%	70%	67%	53%	70%	63%	
(a) sizes G↑I↑/G↑I↓/G↓I↑/G↓I↓	2/2/0/1	2/3/1/4	4/3/1/4	7/6/2/2	10/11/3/6	11/14/6/7	1
(b) sizes	0/3/1/1	1/4/3/2	2/4/3/3	3/6/2/6	5/12/5/8	6/13/6/12	

▼ **Full 48-industry classification table (rationale, betas, t-stats, out-of-sample stability)**

β = change in annualised quarterly excess-of-market return (%) per 1σ move in the macro surprise. "OOS = full-sample" = share of years in which the out-of-sample classification matched the full-sample one.

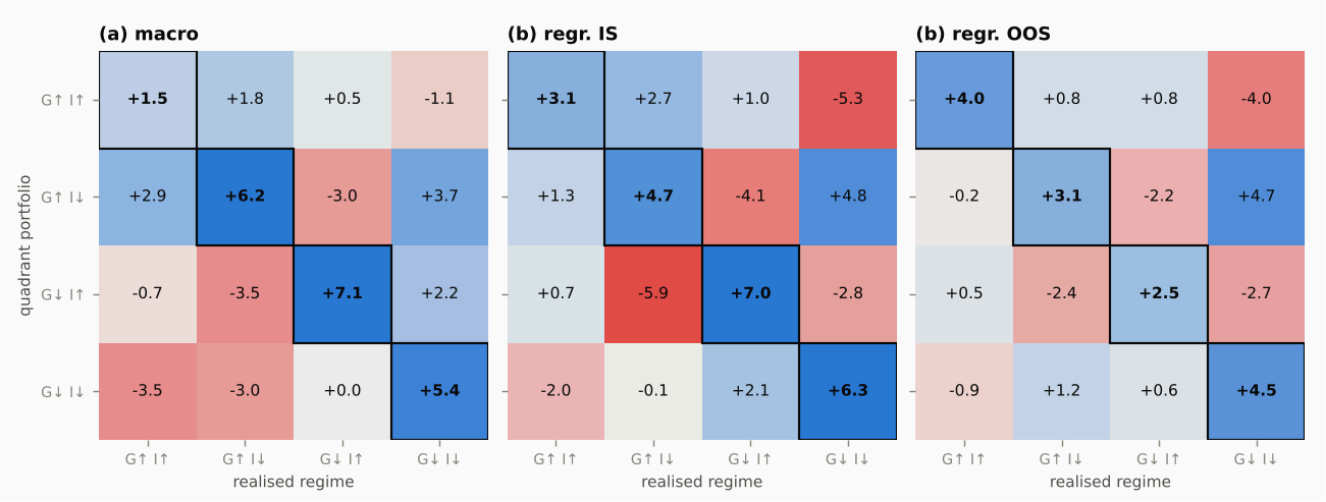
INDUSTRY	(A) QUADRANT	(A) RATIONALE	B GROWTH	T	B INFL.	
Agric	G↓ I↑	Farm output = food commodities; inelastic demand, prices spike in supply shocks	-1.03	-1.8	+0.83	+1
Food	G↓ I↑	Staple demand, owns commodity inventory and passes food inflation through	-1.14	-3.3	-0.02	-(
Soda	G↓ I↓	Branded long-duration staple; bond-proxy, margin squeezed by input costs	-0.17	-0.2	-0.42	-(
Beer	G↓ I↓	Defensive branded staple; long-duration cash flows	-0.26	-0.8	-0.59	-1
Smoke	G↓ I↑	Most inelastic demand in the market; proven pricing power through excise hikes	-0.12	-0.2	-0.35	-(
Toys	G↑ I↓	Discretionary spend, imported inputs	+1.08	+1.2	-0.90	-1
Fun	G↑ I↓	Leisure / entertainment is first to be cut in a slowdown	+0.47	+0.8	-1.84	-2
Books	G↑ I↓	Publishing & advertising cyclical; paper cost squeeze	+0.05	+0.1	-0.31	-(
Hshld	G↓ I↓	Consumer staples (soap, cosmetics); bond-like	-0.11	-0.3	-0.29	-(
Clths	G↑ I↓	Discretionary apparel; cotton/labour input costs	+1.14	+2.6	-1.45	-2
Hlth	G↓ I↓	Healthcare services: non-cyclical, reimbursement lags inflation	+0.29	+0.3	-1.44	-1
MedEq	G↓ I↓	Defensive growth, long duration	-0.60	-1.2	-0.52	-1
Drugs	G↓ I↓	Defensive, long-duration patents; regulated pricing	-1.10	-2.8	-0.08	-(
Chems	G↑ I↑	Commodity chemicals: volume cyclical, prices track oil/feedstock	+0.46	+1.7	+0.00	+(
Rubbr	G↑ I↓	Cyclical volumes, oil-based inputs squeeze margins	+0.25	+0.6	-0.44	-1
Txtls	G↑ I↓	Cyclical, commodity fibre inputs squeeze margins	+1.30	+2.6	-0.53	-(
BldMt	G↑ I↑	Construction materials: capex/housing cycle, real-asset pricing	+0.02	+0.1	-0.52	-1
Cnstr	G↑ I↑	Construction volume pro-cyclical; contracts re-price with inflation	-0.04	-0.1	-0.98	-2
Steel	G↑ I↑	Highest-beta industrial commodity producer	+1.19	+2.8	+1.46	+3
FabPr	G↑ I↑	Metal fabrication; industrial cycle	+0.42	+0.4	+0.35	+(

INDUSTRY	(A) QUADRANT	(A) RATIONALE	B GROWTH	T	B INFL.	
Mach	G↑ I↑	Capex cycle, late-cycle when capacity is tight	+0.84	+3.1	+0.78	+2
ElcEq	G↑ I↓	Capital goods with tech content; long-duration	+0.48	+1.3	-0.18	-(
Autos	G↑ I↓	Durable credit-financed purchase, hurt by rising rates	+1.19	+2.2	-0.68	-1
Aero	G↑ I↓	Aircraft demand follows travel/capex; fuel cost sensitive	+0.49	+0.9	-0.86	-2
Ships	G↑ I↑	Ship/rail equipment; trade & commodity-transport cycle	+0.56	+1.2	+0.41	+(
Guns	G↓ I↑	Defence: counter-cyclical government spend, war-time inflation	-0.79	-1.2	-0.15	-(
Gold	G↓ I↑	Gold = real store of value; rallies on stagflation and falling real rates	-2.37	-1.8	+2.48	+1
Mines	G↑ I↑	Industrial metals: global growth and commodity inflation	+0.99	+2.2	+0.73	+1
Coal	G↑ I↑	Energy commodity tied to industrial power demand	-0.31	-0.3	+3.33	+3
Oil	G↓ I↑	Energy price shocks are the archetypal stagflation (1973, 1979, 2022)	-0.44	-0.9	+1.59	+2
Util	G↓ I↓	Regulated bond-proxy; tariffs lag inflation, rates hurt valuation	-1.40	-3.8	+0.27	+(
Telcm	G↓ I↓	Utility-like, leveraged, long duration	-0.32	-1.0	+0.02	+(
PerSv	G↓ I↓	Personal services (education, funeral): defensive	+0.10	+0.2	-1.36	-3
BusSv	G↑ I↓	Business services/IT services: corporate spend, long duration	+0.00	+0.0	-0.73	-2
Comps	G↑ I↓	Technology: long-duration growth, hurt by rising discount rates	+0.12	+0.3	+0.02	+(
Chips	G↑ I↓	Semis: highest-beta tech cycle, long duration	+0.59	+1.3	-0.26	-(
LabEq	G↑ I↓	Instruments: capex & R&D spend	-0.25	-0.6	-0.05	-(
Paper	G↑ I↑	Pulp & paper commodity cycle	+0.67	+1.7	+0.61	+1
Boxes	G↑ I↑	Packaging volumes track industrial production; pass-through pricing	-0.13	-0.4	-0.31	-(
Trans	G↑ I↑	Freight volumes cyclical; railroads own real assets	+1.26	+4.0	-0.15	-(

INDUSTRY	(A) QUADRANT	(A) RATIONALE	B GROWTH	T	B INFL.	
Whlsl	G↑ I↑	Inventory gains when prices rise; volume cyclical	-0.15	-0.4	-0.35	-1
Rtail	G↑ I↓	Consumer discretionary; real-income squeeze under inflation	+0.09	+0.3	-1.35	-3
Meals	G↑ I↓	Restaurants: discretionary, food & wage cost squeeze	+0.43	+1.0	-1.90	-3
Banks	G↑ I↑	Steeper curve & higher rates lift NIM; credit losses fall with growth	-0.85	-1.9	-0.48	-1
Insur	G↓ I↓	Bond portfolios + claims inflation; defensive	-0.62	-1.7	+0.27	+0
RlEst	G↑ I↑	Real assets re-price with inflation; development is cyclical	+0.36	+0.7	-0.81	-1
Fin	G↑ I↓	Brokers/asset managers: asset-price levels, falling rates	+0.21	+0.8	-0.63	-2
Other	G↓ I↓	Residual conglomerates; no clear exposure (assigned defensive)	+0.31	+0.6	-0.10	-0

4 Does the classification work?

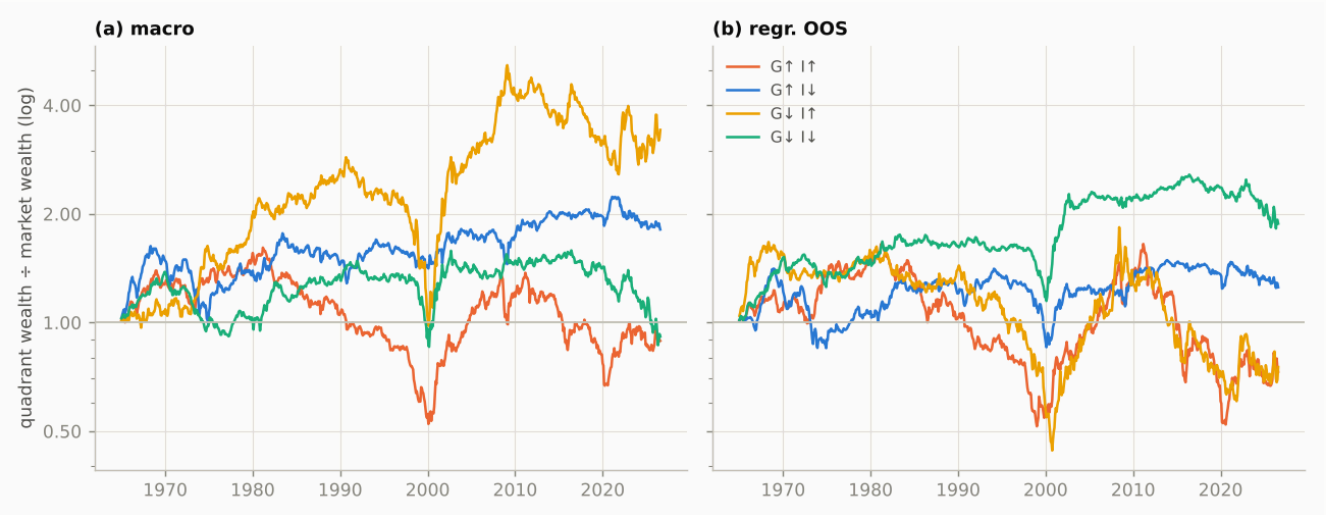
The direct test: in which realised regimes does each quadrant portfolio beat the market? If the classification is right, the diagonal should be the best cell in each row. For (a) this is a genuine test, since the scores were set from economics rather than fitted. For (b) in-sample the diagonal is partly built in, which is why the out-of-sample panel matters.



Average annualised quarterly return of each 48-industry quadrant portfolio (equal-weighted) minus the market, by realised regime, Jan 1965 – Aug 2026. Outlined: own regime.

All three panels have a positive diagonal. The macro view gives the cleanest pattern: its stagflation basket returns +7.1% a year over the market in stagflation quarters and −3.5% in

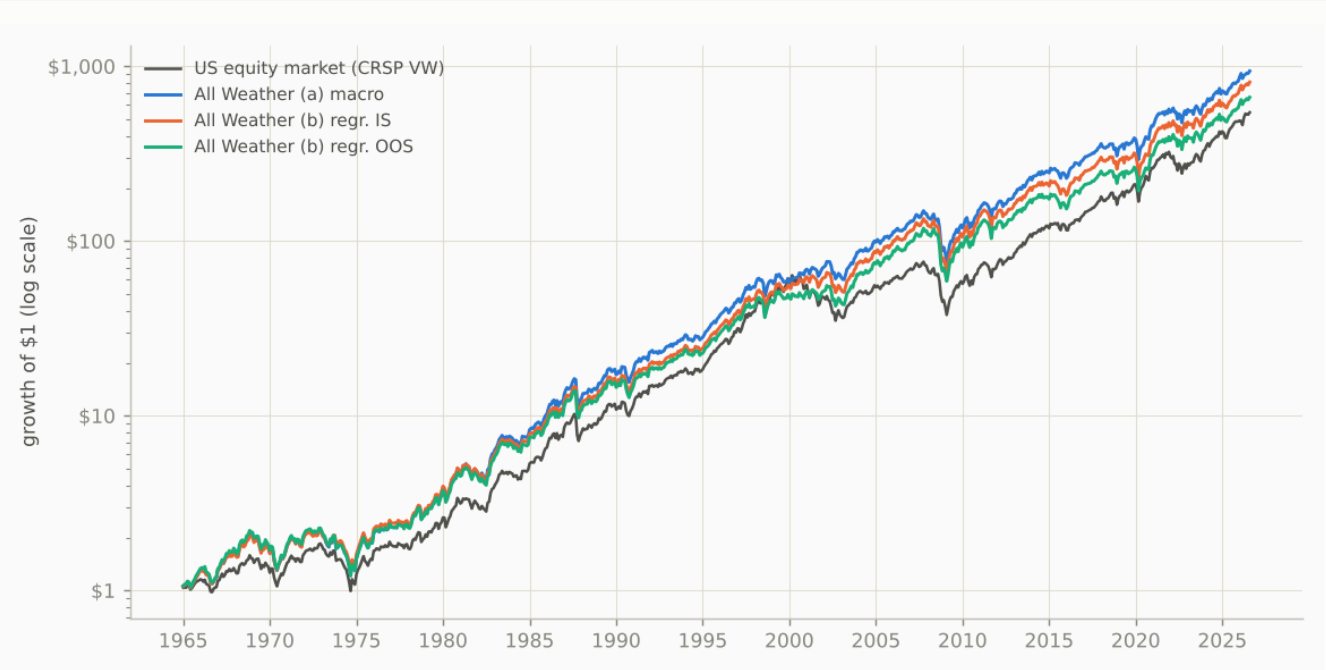
goldilocks quarters. In the macro view the reflation (G↑ I↑) quadrant is the weakest, because industrial cyclicals respond to growth more than to inflation. Over the long run the quadrant portfolios drift a long way apart against the market. That dispersion is what an equal-risk mix diversifies.



Wealth of each quadrant portfolio divided by market wealth (log scale), 48 industries, equal-weighted. Left: macro view. Right: out-of-sample regression view.

5 The 48-industry All Weather portfolio

Base case: industries equal-weighted within each quadrant, quadrants equal-weighted in All Weather, rebalanced monthly. The table adds the equal-weighted average of all 48 industries as a benchmark. Some of any industry strategy's edge over the cap-weighted market comes from equal weighting itself, and this separates the two.

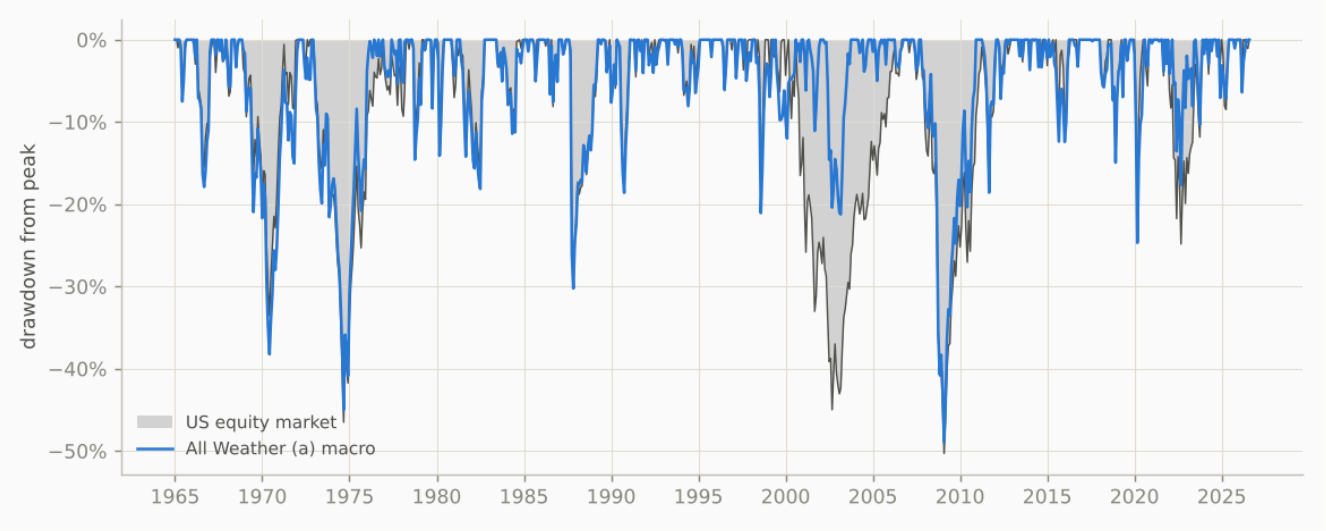


Growth of $1, log scale. All Weather variants use equal weights within and across quadrants.

	CAGR	VOL	SHARPE	SORTINO	MAXDD	CALMAR	WORST 12M	BETA
US equity market	10.8%	15.6%	0.46	0.64	-50.3%	0.21	-42.6%	1.00
All industries, EW	11.5%	16.9%	0.47	0.66	-52.7%	0.22	-46.5%	1.04
All Weather (a) macro	11.7%	16.0%	0.50	0.69	-48.9%	0.24	-43.5%	0.98
All Weather (b) regr. IS	11.5%	16.5%	0.48	0.67	-51.2%	0.22	-46.1%	1.00
All Weather (b) regr. OOS	11.1%	16.8%	0.45	0.64	-50.2%	0.22	-45.7%	1.02
All Weather (a) ERC/ERC	11.8%	15.1%	0.53	0.72	-46.6%	0.25	-40.9%	0.92

All Weather (a) beats both the market and the equal-weighted industry average on every risk-adjusted measure. The edge over the market is around 1% a year, with near-identical volatility. Beta stays near one: this is a better-diversified equity portfolio, not a different asset class.

Drawdowns



Drawdown from running peak. Shaded: market. Line: All Weather (a), equal-weighted.

All Weather (a): five worst drawdowns

	START	TROUGH	RECOVERY	DEPTH
#1	Nov 2007	Feb 2009	Dec 2010	-48.9%
#2	Jan 1973	Sep 1974	Jun 1976	-45.0%
#3	Dec 1968	Jun 1970	Feb 1972	-38.2%
#4	Sep 1987	Nov 1987	Apr 1989	-30.2%
#5	Jan 2020	Mar 2020	Aug 2020	-24.7%

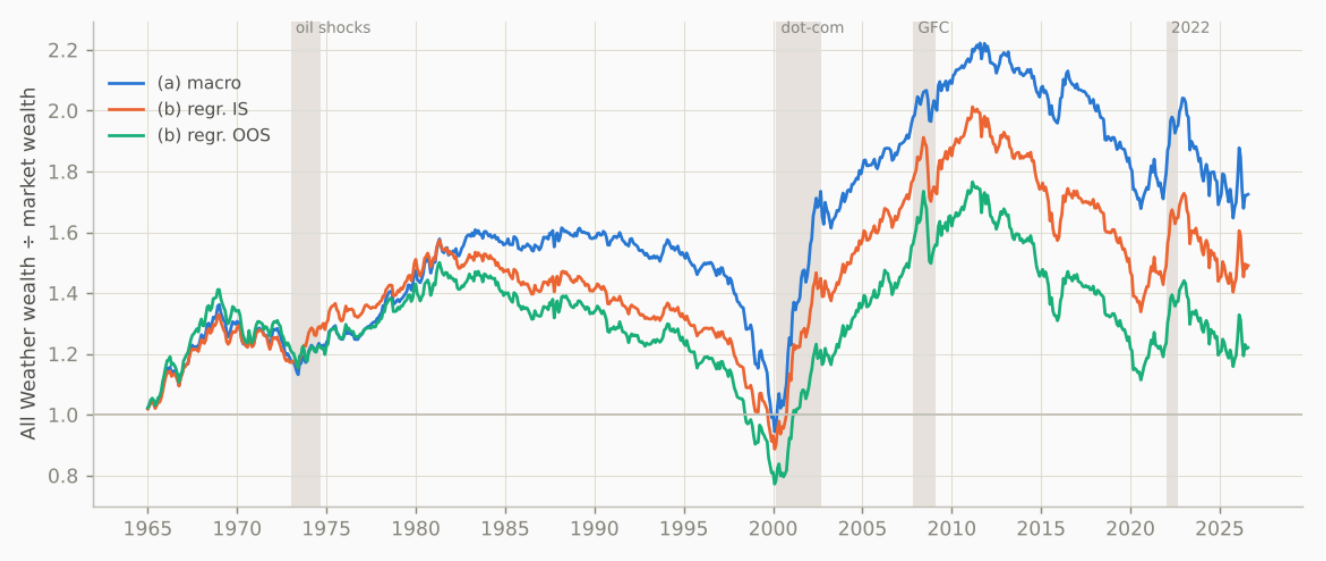
Market: five worst drawdowns

	START	TROUGH	RECOVERY	DEPTH
#1	Nov 2007	Feb 2009	Feb 2012	-50.3%
#2	Jan 1973	Sep 1974	Dec 1976	-46.5%
#3	Sep 2000	Sep 2002	Sep 2006	-45.0%
#4	Dec 1968	Jun 1970	Jan 1972	-33.6%
#5	Sep 1987	Nov 1987	May 1989	-29.9%

Behaviour in stress episodes

	MARKET	(A) MACRO	(B) REGR. IS	(B) REGR. OOS
1973–74 oil shock	-46.5%	-45.0%	-41.5%	-46.7%
1980–82 Volcker	-16.3%	-12.5%	-16.5%	-15.0%
2000–02 dot-com bust	-45.0%	-7.5%	-16.6%	-16.2%
2007–09 GFC	-50.3%	-48.9%	-51.2%	-50.2%
2020 Covid crash	-20.2%	-24.7%	-26.8%	-27.1%
2022 inflation shock	-24.8%	-16.5%	-15.7%	-15.6%

The pattern is clear. When the market falls on a **concentrated regime bet**, All Weather protects. The 2000–02 bust was a goldilocks/tech unwind and the 2022 sell-off was an inflation shock; in both, the stagflation and defensive quadrants offset the losers. In **systemic** sell-offs (1973–74, 2008, March 2020) every industry falls together and the quadrant structure cannot help. In March 2020 the cyclical and energy-heavy quadrants fell more than the market. Bonds, which All Weather lacks here, are the missing hedge.



All Weather wealth divided by market wealth. Rising = outperforming. Shaded: stress episodes.

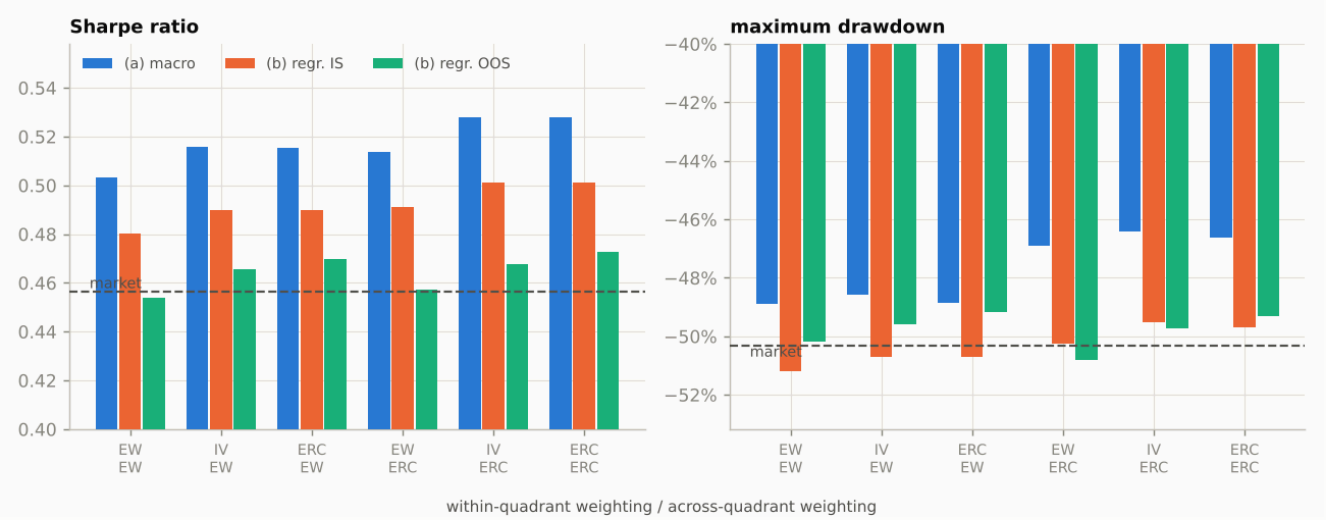
Excess return vs market by realised regime

	G↑ I↑ (54Q)	G↑ I↓ (60Q)	G↓ I↑ (75Q)	G↓ I↓ (57Q)
(a) macro	+0.0%	+0.4%	+1.1%	+2.5%
(b) regr. IS	+0.7%	+0.4%	+1.4%	+0.7%
(b) regr. OOS	+0.8%	+0.7%	+0.3%	+0.6%

The macro-view portfolio beats the market on average in all four regimes, most in disinflationary busts and stagflation, and roughly matches it in reflation. That is what "all weather" should mean for a relative-to-market portfolio.

6 Weighting variants

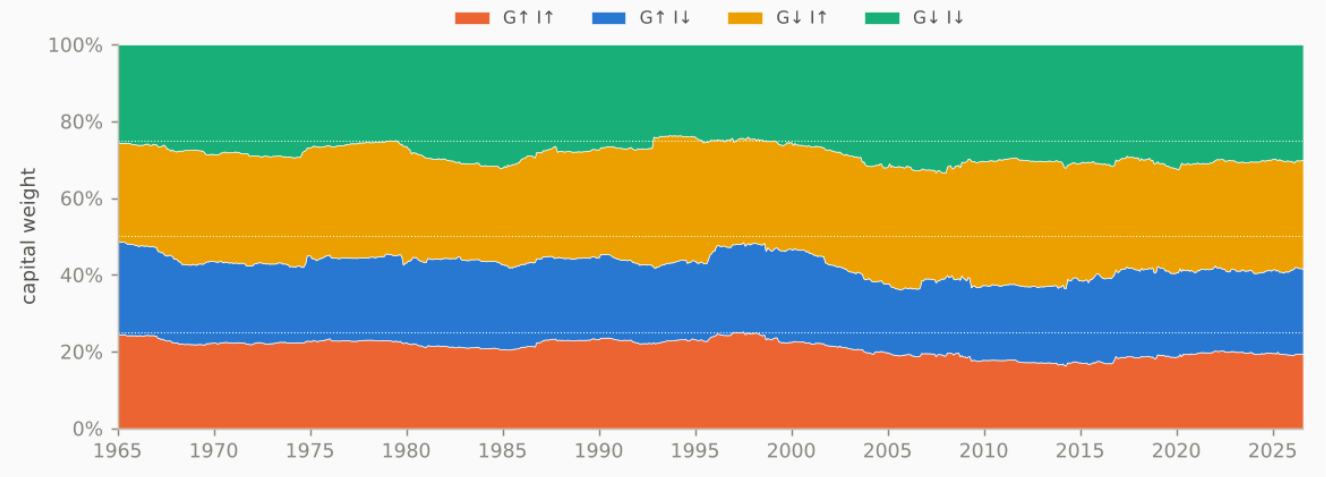
Within each quadrant: equal weight (EW), inverse volatility (IV) or equal risk contribution (ERC) of the industries. Across quadrants: EW or ERC of the four quadrant portfolios. Risk models use 60 months of returns (ERC covariance shrunk 20% toward its diagonal), estimated with data to t−1. Turnover is annual one-way and includes drift.



48 industries. Dashed line: market. Labels read within-quadrant / across-quadrant scheme.

	CAGR	VOL	SHARPE	MAXDD	CALMAR	BETA	ALPHA	TURNOVER
(a) macro · EW / EW	11.7%	16.0%	0.50	-48.9%	0.24	0.98	1.1%	19%
(a) macro · IV / EW	11.8%	15.6%	0.52	-48.6%	0.24	0.95	1.3%	19%
(a) macro · ERC / EW	11.8%	15.5%	0.52	-48.8%	0.24	0.95	1.3%	20%
(a) macro · EW / ERC	11.8%	15.7%	0.51	-46.9%	0.25	0.95	1.3%	20%
(a) macro · IV / ERC	11.8%	15.2%	0.53	-46.4%	0.25	0.92	1.4%	20%
(a) macro · ERC / ERC	11.8%	15.1%	0.53	-46.6%	0.25	0.92	1.5%	21%
(b) regr. IS · EW / EW	11.5%	16.5%	0.48	-51.2%	0.22	1.00	0.8%	19%
(b) regr. IS · IV / EW	11.4%	15.9%	0.49	-50.7%	0.23	0.97	0.9%	19%
(b) regr. IS · ERC / EW	11.4%	15.8%	0.49	-50.7%	0.23	0.97	0.9%	20%
(b) regr. IS · EW / ERC	11.5%	16.1%	0.49	-50.3%	0.23	0.98	0.9%	20%
(b) regr. IS · IV / ERC	11.5%	15.4%	0.50	-49.5%	0.23	0.95	1.0%	20%
(b) regr. IS · ERC / ERC	11.5%	15.4%	0.50	-49.7%	0.23	0.95	1.0%	21%
(b) regr. OOS · EW / EW	11.1%	16.8%	0.45	-50.2%	0.22	1.02	0.4%	23%
(b) regr. OOS · IV / EW	11.1%	16.2%	0.47	-49.6%	0.22	0.99	0.5%	23%
(b) regr. OOS · ERC / EW	11.2%	16.1%	0.47	-49.2%	0.23	0.98	0.6%	24%
(b) regr. OOS · EW / ERC	11.1%	16.6%	0.46	-50.8%	0.22	1.01	0.5%	24%
(b) regr. OOS · IV / ERC	11.1%	16.0%	0.47	-49.7%	0.22	0.98	0.5%	23%
(b) regr. OOS · ERC / ERC	11.1%	15.9%	0.47	-49.3%	0.23	0.97	0.6%	25%

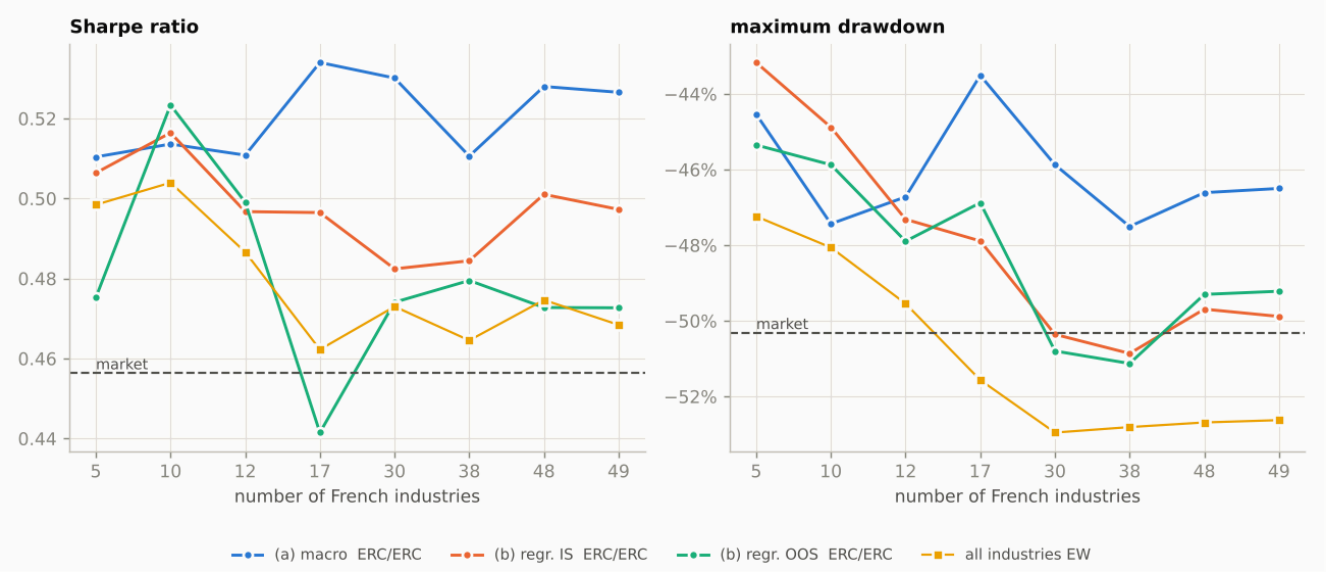
Risk-based weighting helps consistently but modestly: about +0.01 Sharpe from IV or ERC within quadrants and another +0.01 from ERC across them, which also takes 2–3 points off the maximum drawdown. The two steps add about the same Sharpe, but only ERC across quadrants reduces drawdowns. It cuts the growth quadrants to about 21% of capital each and raises the two growth-down quadrants to about 29% each. That is the true risk-parity step, and the equity analogue of Bridgewater levering up bonds. Turnover stays around 20% a year for all schemes. The classification choice, (a) vs (b) vs (b-OOS), matters about twice as much as the weighting scheme.



Capital weights of the four quadrants under ERC across quadrants (48 industries, macro view, ERC within). Equal risk means unequal capital: the lower-volatility growth-down quadrants get the most.

7 Industry granularity: 5 to 49 industries

French publishes 5, 10, 12, 17, 30, 38, 48 and 49 industry sets (there is no 11, 20 or 120). We hand-classified every set with view (a) and re-ran the regressions (b) for each.



All Weather with ERC within and across quadrants, plus the equal-weighted all-industry benchmark. Dashed line: market.

Sharpe ratio

	5	10	12	17
(a) macro EW/EW	0.51	0.50	0.49	0.51
(a) macro ERC/ERC	0.51	0.51	0.51	0.53
(b) regr. IS EW/EW	0.50	0.51	0.49	0.47
(b) regr. IS ERC/ERC	0.51	0.52	0.50	0.50
(b) regr. OOS EW/EW	0.48	0.51	0.49	0.42
(b) regr. OOS ERC/ERC	0.48	0.52	0.50	0.44
all industries EW	0.50	0.50	0.49	0.46

Maximum drawdown

	5	10	12
(a) macro EW/EW	-45.0%	-48.7%	-48.1%
(a) macro ERC/ERC	-44.5%	-47.4%	-46.7%
(b) regr. IS EW/EW	-44.2%	-47.0%	-49.2%
(b) regr. IS ERC/ERC	-43.2%	-44.9%	-47.3%
(b) regr. OOS EW/EW	-46.4%	-47.5%	-49.2%
(b) regr. OOS ERC/ERC	-45.4%	-45.9%	-47.9%
all industries EW	-47.2%	-48.1%	-49.5%

More industries do not mean better macro balance. The macro view is stable from 5 to 49 (Sharpe 0.51–0.53), and the 17-industry set has the shallowest drawdown. The regression views are less stable. With few industries, a single misclassified sector moves a whole quadrant, and the 5- and 10-industry sets need a borrowed industry to fill the stagflation quadrant. With many, the t-statistics are noisier. The equal-weighted benchmark gets *worse* with granularity, because finer sets over-weight small cyclical niches. The quadrant structure stops that from happening, which is a direct way to see its diversification value.

8 Conclusions and next steps

- The growth/inflation framework transfers well to equity industries as a **relative-value** map. Industries sort reliably into regime winners and losers, and an economically reasoned classification holds up better than a fitted one.
- An industry-only All Weather is a **better-diversified equity portfolio**: Sharpe 0.50–0.53 vs 0.46, slightly smaller drawdowns, strong protection against concentration unwinds. It is not a multi-asset crash hedge.
- Prefer **ERC across quadrants**, the step that actually equalises regime risk, together with the macro classification. Industry granularity is a second-order choice; 17–48 industries is a sensible range.

Suggested extensions. (1) Isolate the regime overlay: long each quadrant, short the market, ERC across the four spreads. This is a market-neutral macro factor that could sit alongside bonds and commodities in a true multi-asset All Weather. (2) Measure surprises against expectations (Survey of Professional Forecasters, breakevens) rather than as changes in realised data. (3) Use time-varying, shrunk betas for (b), Bayesian-blended with the (a) priors. (4) Lever to a target volatility and add transaction costs.

9 Method and data notes

- **Returns:** Kenneth French value-weighted monthly industry portfolios (5...49), CRSP 2026-08 vintage. Market = Mkt-RF + RF from the Fama-French research factors. Missing values (−99.99) are treated as not investable.
- **Eligibility:** an industry is held from month t only if it has 36 consecutive months of returns to t−1 (for example, Gold, Soda, Guns and FabPr enter in the mid-1960s). Quadrant portfolios are built from 1931 to give the across-quadrant risk models history. All results are reported over Jan 1965 – Aug 2026, the window where the out-of-sample classification exists.
- **Look-ahead:** weights use only past returns. Classification (a) and (b) are static over the full sample. (b) is in-sample by construction, and (b-OOS) is the honest benchmark for it. (a) uses no fitted data, but it is written with today's knowledge of industry economics.
- **Not included:** transaction costs (turnover is about 20% a year one-way, so cost drag is small), leverage, taxes.
- **Code:** `allweather/` package (data, classify, portfolio, analytics, figures), `run.py` (study grid), `report.py` and `build_html.py` (this page).

Sources: Kenneth R. French Data Library (Dartmouth Tuck); FRED, Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis; Bridgewater Associates, "The All Weather Story". Past performance of back-tested portfolios is hypothetical and does not include costs.